

November: The Robotic Arm

Victor Scheinman designed the Stanford Arm, the first successful electrically-powered, computer-controlled robot arm. It had six joints and was operated by a PDP-6 computer. It was used to develop assembly techniques for robots in an industrial environment.

CompuServe Starts Up

The CompuServe Information Service was launched. Based in Ohio, the first computer time-sharing service available to the public, allowed users to connect to the network through dialup lines. It is considered the first commercial online service.

The Coming Of The Serial Port

The EIA (Electronic Industries Association) standardised the RS-232 interface. This interface allowed computers and peripheral devices to transmit information serially. The RS-232 interface was also called the serial port.

Multiplayer Games

Rick Blomme wrote a two-player version of Spacewar! for the PLATO (Programmed Logic for Automatic Teaching Operations) system which supported multi user time sharing. It allowed two users on different terminals connected to the system to play, making it the first multiplayer game.

1969 saw Busicom asking Intel to manufacture what became the first microprocessor. 1971 saw it completed. Read on...